

# Comparatives and superlatives

ADJECTIVES CAN BE USED TO COMPARE NOUNS OR PRONOUNS.

Comparatives and superlatives are special types of adjectives that are used to compare two or more things. Most comparatives are formed using the ending *-er*, and most superlatives are formed using the ending *-est*.

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◀ 26–27 Adjectives

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- **Never use double** comparatives or double superlatives—“more prettier” and “most prettiest” are wrong.
- Not every adjective has a comparative or superlative form. *Unique*, *square*, *round*, *excellent*, and *perfect* are all words that can't be graded.

## Comparatives

A comparative adjective is used to compare two people or things. It is formed by adding the ending *-er* to all one-syllable adjectives and some two-syllable adjectives. When two nouns are being compared in a sentence, they are usually linked using the preposition *than*.

The Ferris wheel is **bigger** than the carousel.

This word is used to link the two nouns being compared: the Ferris wheel and the carousel.

The Ferris wheel is **bigger** than the the **biggest** ride of all. The ghost

## Superlatives

Superlative adjectives can be used to compare two or more people or things. They are formed by adding the ending *-est* to one-syllable adjectives, and using the word *the* in front of them: “the biggest ride.”

big  
bigger  
biggest

small  
smaller  
smallest

thin  
thinner  
thinnest

## REAL WORLD

### Biggest and best

Multiple superlatives are often used in advertisements to sell things, whether they're books, vacations, or circus attractions. Words like *greatest*, *best*, and *cheapest* enable a seller to exaggerate the quality or value of the product being sold, making it more appealing to potential customers. Superlatives should be used in moderation in formal text, however.